INCH-POUND

MIL-P-44432
8 November 1991

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

PORK CHOW MEIN, THERMOSTABILIZED, FOR MEAL, READY-TO-EAT

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers thermostabilized pork chow mein in flexible pouches for use as a component of the Meal, Ready-to-Eat, Individual.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-P-44073 - Packaging and Thermoprocessing of Foods in Flexible Pouches

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5018 by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A

FSC 8940

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STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-900 - Bacterial Standards for Starches, Flours, Cereals, Alimentary Pastes, Dry Milks, and Sugars Used in the Preparation of Thermostabilized Foods for the Armed Forces

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Copies are available from the Office of Drinking Water, Environmental Protection Agency, WH550D, 401 M Street, S.W., Washington, DC 20460.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

Institutional Meat Purchase Specifications for Fresh Pork, Series 400

(Copies are available from the Director, Livestock and Seed Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2603, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Mushrooms

(Copies are available from the Director, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2077, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES (HHS)

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

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(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)

AMERICAN DEHYDRATED ONION AND GARLIC ASSOCIATION (ADOGA)

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, 650 California Street, Suite 800, San Francisco, CA 94108.)

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 2200 Wilson Boulevard, Suite 400-CD, Arlington, VA 22201-3301.)

NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCES

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

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2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First Article. When specified (see 6.1), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.2) in accordance with 4.4.

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Pork. Pork shall be derived from any one or any combination of the following USDA Certified Institutional Meat Purchase Specification (IMPS) Cuts: Item No. 402B (fresh ham, boneless, tied), 402C (fresh ham, boneless, trimmed, tied), 405A (shoulder, picnic, boneless), 405B (shoulder, picnic, cushion, boneless), 406A (shoulder, boston butt, boneless), 407 (shoulder butt, cellar trimmed, boneless), and 413 (loin, boneless). All pork shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) Certificate to certify condition of the product and compliance with the Institutional Meat Purchase Specifications quality assurance provisions.

3.2.1.1 Handling and storage. Handling and storage of the boned and trimmed pork, prior to processing into the finished product, shall be in accordance with the following requirements:

a. Pork processed on the day of initial certification shall be maintained in the temperature range of 28° to 50°F, inclusive.

b. Holding in the fresh-chilled state for not more than 4 days after initial certification is permitted, provided that the pork is maintained in the temperature range of 28° to 40°F, inclusive.

c. Holding in the frozen state for not more than 180 days after initial certification is permitted, provided that the pork is:

- frozen to 0°F or lower within 72 hours after initial certification
- stored at 0°F or lower
- protected from freezer deterioration and damage
- stored in containers that are adequate to maintain product excellence
- held after storage at an internal temperature not to exceed 40°F when further processing is resumed
- not refrozen after it has been tempered/thawed

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NOTE: Microwave tempering/thawing of the frozen pork is permitted provided that the pork is maintained in excellent condition, as determined by the USDA.

3.2.2 Pork, cooked, frozen. Cooked, frozen pork dices shall be prepared from pork that complies with 3.2.1 and 3.2.1.1. The pork shall be processed in accordance with 3.3.1. The cooked pork dices shall be packaged and sealed in a USDA approved food packaging material and shall be frozen to an internal temperature of 0°F or below within 72 hours. The initial freezing (in-storage) date and processing and packaging requirements shall be certified by a USDA AMS Livestock Division Agent. The packaged, frozen, cooked pork dices shall have been held at an internal temperature of 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 120 days prior to pouch filling (see 3.4).

3.2.3 Water. Water used for formulation, rehydration, blanching, ice making, and washing shall conform to the National Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.2.4 Water chestnuts, sliced, canned. The canned sliced water chestnuts shall be packed in water. The color of the canned water chestnuts shall be white to off-white, and the slice thickness shall be 0.1 to 0.2 inches. The water chestnuts shall be of the latest date of pack.

3.2.5 Celery, fresh. Celery shall be fresh, crisp, white (blanched) or green variety. The celery shall be free from pithy branches, seed stems, and damage.

3.2.6 Mushrooms, canned, pieces and stems. The canned pieces and stems shall be U.S. Grade B or better in accordance with the U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Mushrooms. The mushrooms shall be drained prior to use in the formulation. The mushrooms shall be of the latest season's pack.

3.2.7 Starch, waxy maize, modified. Starch shall be white, odorless, finely pulverized, modified waxy maize starch for use in thermostabilized foods. The modified starch shall demonstrate initial viscosity development in the temperature range of 140° to 170°F and a typical viscosity (be fully hydrated) at common retort temperatures. The starch shall resist breakdown at low pH, under shear stress, and under conditions of cold storage. The starch shall be bland with essentially no cereal or starch taste and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.8 Sauce, soy. The soy sauce shall have been prepared from water, wheat, soybeans, and salt. The soy sauce shall contain not more than 0.10 percent sodium benzoate as a preservative and shall have a titratable acidity of not less than 1.8 percent or more than 2.2 percent. The flavor shall be tart, sweet, salty, with a definite fermented bouquet. The soy sauce shall be a clear, reddish brown color with no visual impurities. The soy sauce shall be of the latest date of pack.

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3.2.9 Oil, vegetable. Vegetable oil shall possess a clean, bland flavor, and shall have a minimum stability of 15 hours (A.O.M.), have a free fatty acid value not to exceed 0.05 percent, have a moisture/volatile matter content not to exceed 0.06 percent, and shall pass a cold test of 5.5 hours (minimum).

3.2.10 Onions, dehydrated, chopped. Dehydrated chopped onions shall be Fancy Grade of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

3.2.11 Salt. Salt shall be noniodized, white, refined sodium chloride with or without anticaking agents and shall comply with the purity standards for sodium chloride of the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.12 Sugar, white, granulated. Sugar shall be white, refined, granulated cane or beet sugar, or a combination thereof, and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.13 Lecithin. Lecithin shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.14 Pepper, black, ground. Ground black pepper shall have been ground from the deep brown to black, deep-set, wrinkled, immature berries of Piper nigrum L. The ground pepper shall have a characteristic, penetrating odor, a hot, biting, pungent flavor, and a light gray to speckled black-gray color. The ground pepper shall contain not less than 2.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground black pepper and be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 16 sieve.

3.2.15 Flavor enhancer. The flavor enhancer shall be a mixture of disodium inosinate (Sodium 5'-inosinate) and disodium guanylate (Sodium 5'-guanylate) in a 1:1 ratio. The flavor enhancer shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.16 Garlic powder. Garlic powder shall be Fancy Grade of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

3.2.17 Starch, waxy maize, modified, filling and processing aid. Starch shall be white to off-white, odorless, finely pulverized powder suitable for use as a filling and processing aid in thermostabilized foods. When hydrated at temperatures of 165° to 200°F, the starch shall develop a paste. The initial viscosity of the paste shall be retained under conditions of moderate shear and prolonged holding times. During retorting at temperatures in excess of 200°F, the starch shall undergo extensive to complete breakdown of the initial viscosity. The starch shall be bland, shall demonstrate easy dispersibility, and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

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3.2.18 Preblended spice and seasoning mixture. Preblended spices and seasonings may be used. The spices and seasonings in the mixture shall comply with the requirements of this document. The containers used for the spice and seasoning blend shall be labeled with each ingredient and the percentage of each ingredient in the blend. The ingredients shall be in the same proportions as specified in the ingredient formulation.

3.3 Preparation and processing. Processing shall be on a continuous basis.

3.3.1 Preparation of pork.

a. Boned and trimmed pork which meets the requirements of 3.2.1 shall be further trimmed, if necessary, to ensure compliance with finished product requirements.

b. The pork shall be diced to yield uniform dices of 5/8 by 5/8 by 5/8 inch dimensions. The pork dices shall be screened for the elimination of fines.

c. The raw pork dices shall be held for not more than 24 hours at an internal temperature of 28° to 40°F from the time of dicing to the beginning of the cooking process.

d. The dices shall be cooked in water until a yield of 75 percent is obtained. The cooked pork dices shall be thoroughly drained.

e. The cooked pork dices shall be held for not more than 48 hours at an internal temperature of 28° to 40°F until filled into pouches or packaged and sealed for frozen storage (see 3.2.2).

3.3.2 Preparation of fresh celery. The fresh celery shall be cleaned thoroughly, trimmed to remove fibrous longitudinal strands, and sliced into 1/2 inch cross-cut stalk slices with no leaf cuts. The sliced celery shall be blanched in 180° to 190°F water for one minute. The blanched celery shall be immediately cooled to the initial temperature of the cooling water and thoroughly drained. The cooled, drained celery shall be handled in a manner to prevent discoloration and filled into the pouches within 4 hours after blanching.

3.3.3 Filling and processing aid starch preparation. When a filling and processing aid starch is used, a solution (slurry) shall be prepared with the filling and processing aid starch and part of the product formulation water in a concentration adequate to hold ingredients in suspension for uniform distribution during mixing and pumping of product.

3.3.4 Product formulation and preparation. The product shall be formulated and prepared as follows:

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Ingredients	Percent by Weight
Water	38.22
Pork, cooked, diced, screened 1/	25.00
Water chestnuts, sliced, canned, drained	11.15
Celery, fresh	8.00
Mushrooms, canned, drained	6.00
Starch, waxy maize, modified	3.00
Sauce, soy	2.70
Oil, vegetable	2.40
Onions, dehydrated, chopped	2.00
Salt 2/	0.70
Sugar, white, granulated	0.44
Lecithin	0.25
Pepper, black, ground	0.10
Flavor enhancer	0.02
Garlic powder	0.02

1/ Dices which have not been properly screened prior to product preparation may cause failure of the finished product intact piece size requirement (see 3.3.1, 3.6 i, and Table III - Major Defect 102).

2/ The total amount of salt in product formula shall be adjusted, as necessary, to produce a product that complies with the finished product salt requirements (see 3.6).

NOTE: The following product preparation procedures were used in the development of this product. Alternate procedures may be used provided finished product requirements are met. (When alternate procedures are used, the time and temperature requirements specified for the prepared product are still applicable.)

a. All ingredients (except the diced pork) shall be combined and heated to 150° to 180°F and held for five minutes.

b. The diced pork shall be added to the mixture and the product shall be mixed only to the extent necessary to ensure a uniform distribution of ingredients.

c. Immediately prior to pouch filling, the volume of the final mixture shall be adjusted with water to compensate for evaporation loss during heating and holding.

d. The product shall be filled into the pouches within 4 hours after preparation.

e. The product shall be held in the temperature range of 150° to 180°F at all times prior to filling into the pouches.

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3.4 Pouch filling and sealing. Each pouch (see 5.1) shall be filled with product to conform to the finished product requirements and to the following requirements:

a. Each pouch shall be filled and sealed in accordance with the pouch filling and sealing requirements specified for class 1 of MIL-P-44073.

b. The temperature of the product at time of pouch filling shall be 150° to 180°F.

c. Each filled and sealed pouch shall be in the retort process within 2 hours after sealing.

3.5 Pouch thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed pouches shall be thermostabilized by retorting until a sterilization value (F_o) of not less than 6 has been achieved. The thermoprocessing operation shall be in compliance with the thermoprocessing requirements for class 1 of MIL-P-44073.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odors or flavors such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. Total weight of cartilage, coarse connective tissue, section of tendons or ligaments, and glandular material, collectively, in any individual pouch shall be not more than 0.35 ounces.

e. No individual pouch shall contain a bone piece measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension.

f. The average net weight shall be not less than 8.0 ounces.

g. No individual pouch shall contain less than 7.5 ounces of product.

h. No individual pouch shall contain less than 3.5 ounces drained weight of pork and vegetables (combined).

i. Of the individual drained weight of product not less than 1.5 ounces shall be whole intact pork dices.

j. The average drained weight shall be not less than 4.0 ounces.

k. Texture of pork dices shall not be dry, rubbery, or mushy.

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l. Texture of vegetables shall not be mushy, hard, fibrous, or tough.

m. Sauce consistency shall be smooth, without lumps, and shall not be excessively thick or thin.

n. The average fat content of the finished product shall be not greater than 5.0 percent and no individual pouch shall have a fat content greater than 7.0 percent.

o. The salt content of the product in any individual pouch shall be not less than 0.50 percent nor greater than 1.50 percent.

p. The product shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

3.6.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The meat component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this specification. The contractor shall ensure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of inspection and supervision necessary to ensure compliance with the requirements of this specification.

4.3 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

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4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this specification or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, and compliance shall be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods such as the standard methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, filling, sealing, and packaging requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation, or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.3 Filled and sealed pouch inspection. Inspection of filled and sealed pouches shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-P-44073.

4.5.4 Net weight examination. The net weight of the filled and sealed pouches shall be determined by weighing each sample unit on a suitable scale tared with a representative empty pouch. Any individual net weight of less than 7.5 ounces shall be classified as a minor defect. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed pouch. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5. Results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce. In addition, the lot shall be rejected if the sample average net weight is less than 8.0 ounces.

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4.5.5 Product and drained weight inspection. The filled and sealed sample pouches shall be held for a minimum of 72 hours at room temperature (65° to 75°F) after completion of the thermoprocessing operation. The pouches shall be heated in 180° to 190°F water for 10 minutes, opened, and inspected. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be the contents of one pouch. The sample size shall be as indicated by the sampling plan specified in table I. The product contents shall be inspected for the defects indicated in table II. The drained weight shall be determined and inspected for the defects indicated in table III.

TABLE I. Double sampling plan for product inspection 1/

Lot size (pouches)	Sample size (pouches)	Cumulative sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0 to 500,000	20	--	0	2
	20	40	1	2

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be inspected. Defects found in the first and second sample shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

TABLE II. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Total weight of cartilage, coarse connective tissue, section of tendons or ligaments, and glandular material, collectively, in any individual pouch is more than 0.35 ounces
102	Presence of a bone piece measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension
103	Texture of pork dices is dry, rubbery, or mushy
104	Texture of vegetables is mushy, hard, fibrous, or tough

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TABLE II. Product defects 1/ 2/ (cont'd)

Category	Defect
Major	
105	Sauce consistency is lumpy, not smooth, and is excessively thick or thin
106	Product shows evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched)

1/ The presence of foreign material (for example, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, metal), foreign odor or flavor (for example, burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, moldy), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot (see 3.6.1).

TABLE III. Drained weight defects 1/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Drained weight of pork and vegetables (combined) in a pouch is less than 3.5 ounces 2/
102	Of the individual drained weight of product in a pouch, less than 1.5 ounces is whole intact pork dices 3/

1/ To determine drained weight, the pouch contents shall be poured into a flat-bottom container. A minimum of three times the pouch's volume of 180° to 190°F water shall be added to the container so as to cover the contents. The contents and water shall be gently agitated so as to liquify rendered fat without breaking the pork dices. The contents shall then be poured into a U.S. Standard No. 7 sieve in a manner that will distribute the product over the sieve without breaking the pork dices. Sieve area shall be such that the distributed product does not completely cover all the openings of the sieve. The sieve shall be tilted at approximately a 45° angle and allowed to drain for 2 minutes before determining the drained weight by subtracting the sieve tare weight from the gross weight. The drained weight shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

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2/ If the sample average drained weight of the product is less than 4.0 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

3/ For purpose of this examination, the definition of a whole intact pork dice is one that measures not less than 1/4 inch in each of two separate dimensions.

4.5.6 Fat and salt content testing. Three filled and sealed pouches shall be selected at random from the lot. The pouches shall be individually tested for fat and salt content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, chapter: Meat and Meat Products, except that preparation of the samples shall be as follows: The unopened pouches shall be gently warmed in a water bath to melt fat adhering to the inside of the pouches. The pouches shall be opened and the entire contents of each pouch shall be separately blended in a Waring Blendor or equivalent. The test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result failing to conform to the fat and salt requirements in 3.6 shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.7 Packaging inspection. Inspection of packaging shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-P-44073.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be in accordance with the requirements of MIL-P-44073.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory).

6.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.2).
d. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.2).

6.2 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209-4. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

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6.3 Subject term (key word) listing.

Combat field feeding
Food processing
Operational rations
Pouch

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review activities:

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DP - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

(Project 8940-0731)

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)
	MIL-P-44432	1991 November 8

3. DOCUMENT TITLE

PORK CHOW MEIN, THERMOSTABILIZED, FOR MEAL, READY-TO-EAT

4. NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)*

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial	(2) AUTOVON/DSN
U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center	508-651-4501	256-4501
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) Commander, U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center ATTN: STRNC-WTP Natick, MA 01760-5018	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

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